



## HOT MESS EXPRESS

### Network Pitch Document

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#### PROJECT TITLE: HOT MESS EXPRESS

**LOGLINE:** When a perfectionist Black supermom finally snaps, she and her two equally-stressed friends stumble into a bizarre Southern B&B where physical disasters, cultural mishaps, and karaoke therapy force them to confront their fears—and destroy several pieces of furniture in the process.

**TONE:** Girls Trip meets Bridesmaids with the heart of Little Big Lies and the physical comedy of Schitt's Creek

**THEME:** Female friendship, embracing imperfection, and finding authenticity in a world obsessed with curated perfection

**PITCH:** "What if three modern women having midlife crises accidentally stumbled into the most therapeutic disaster of their lives? HOT MESS EXPRESS is a raucous female ensemble comedy that tackles perfectionism, divorce anxiety, and creative burnout through the lens of spectacular physical comedy and genuine emotional breakthrough."

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## DETAILED SYNOPSIS

### ACT I: THE PERFECT STORM

Kendra Taylor's Pinterest-perfect life implodes when her husband ruins her great-grandmother's cast-iron skillet. At a school auction, she accidentally triggers a confetti cannon disaster that buries half the PTA in homemade cookies. Her best friend Shauna, a razor-sharp divorce attorney, declares an emergency "wellness retreat" and drags Kendra and free-spirited Lilly to what turns out to be The Monroe House—a Southern Gothic B&B run by the magnificently unhinged Beverly Monroe.

### ACT II: BEAUTIFUL DISASTERS

What starts as a simple weekend getaway becomes a series of escalating physical comedies: disastrous spa treatments that turn faces magenta, mistaken texts that bring husbands rushing to their "rescue," and a karaoke session that ends with the most awkward lawyer-client encounter in history. Each mishap strips away another layer of the women's carefully constructed personas.

### ACT III: EMBRACING THE CHAOS

After destroying a hot tub, triggering security alarms, and creating a human domino effect during a trust exercise, the women finally break down their walls. They return home changed—not perfect, but perfectly imperfect and genuinely happy for the first time in years.

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## CHARACTER BREAKDOWN

**KENDRA TAYLOR** (35, Black) - The Type-A supermom whose life is militantly organized until it spectacularly isn't. Think Kerry Washington's perfectionism meets Tina Fey's physical comedy.

**SHAUNA BELL** (38, Black) - High-powered divorce attorney who cross-examines restaurant servers and objects to weather forecasts. Regina King's intensity with Issa Rae's wit.

**LILLY CHASE** (28, White) - Free-spirited artist whose spiritual solutions create actual disasters. Anna Kendrick's charm with Amy Poehler's optimistic chaos.

**BEVERLY "BEV" MONROE** (62, White) - Eccentric B&B owner who navigates disasters with supernatural grace. Think Catherine O'Hara meets Paula Deen with a dash of fortune teller.

**TRAVIS TURNER** (30, Latino) - Impossibly calm handyman who delivers perfect one-liners while preventing catastrophes. Oscar Isaac's charm with Nick Offerman's competence.

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## TALENT SUGGESTIONS

- **KENDRA TAYLOR:** Regina King, Kerry Washington, Issa Rae, Sanaa Lathan
  - **SHAUNA BELL:** Taraji P. Henson, Angela Bassett, Nia Long, Tika Sumpter
  - **LILLY CHASE:** Anna Kendrick, Kristen Bell, Amy Poehler, Reese Witherspoon
  - **BEVERLY MONROE:** Catherine O'Hara, Jane Lynch, Kristen Wiig, Maya Rudolph
  - **TRAVIS TURNER:** Oscar Isaac, Michael Cera, John Leguizamo, Diego Luna
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## CASTING MOCK-UP GRID



# HOT MESS EXPRESS



**KENDRA**

**Regina  
King**



**SHAUNA**

**Taraji P.  
Henson**



**LILLY**

**Anna  
Kendrick**



# HOT MESS EXPRESS



**BEVERLY  
CATHERINE  
O'HARA**

**TRAVIS  
OSCAR  
ISAAC**



**DAVID  
JASON  
SUDEIKIS**



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## DIRECTOR MATCH SUGGESTIONS

- **PAUL FEIG** - Master of female ensemble comedy (Bridesmaids, The Heat)
  - **GINA PRINCE-BYTHEWOOD** - Authentic female relationships (Girls Trip)
  - **SUSANNA FOGEL** - Smart, character-driven comedy (Booksmart)
  - **MALCOLM D. LEE** - Ensemble chemistry and cultural authenticity (Girls Trip)
  - **SHAWN LEVY** - Heart + chaos (Schitt's Creek producer)
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## LOOKBOOK/MOOD REEL REFERENCES

### VISUAL TONE:

- Girls Trip (female friendship authenticity)
- Schitt's Creek (controlled chaos, heart)
- Bridesmaids (physical comedy escalation)
- Big Little Lies (suburban perfection facade)
- The White Lotus (vacation gone wrong)

### COMEDY STYLE:

- Broad City (friendship chemistry)
  - Insecure (authentic dialogue)
  - Ted Lasso (optimism through disaster)
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## MARKETING HOOKS & PROMO-READY TAGLINES

**PRIMARY:** "Sometimes you have to break a few rules... and a few things... to fix yourself."

### ADDITIONAL TAGLINES:

- "All aboard the Hot Mess Express!"
- "Friendship is beautiful. Friendship is messy. Friendship is worth it."
- "Three friends. One weekend. Maximum chaos."
- "When perfect goes wrong, friendship goes right."

## MARKETING HOOKS:

- First major comedy to authentically blend Black and white female friendship dynamics
  - Physical comedy meets emotional breakthrough
  - "Girls Trip meets Schitt's Creek"
  - Social media goldmine of relatable mom chaos
  - Soundtrack potential with karaoke disasters
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## TARGET AUDIENCE & MARKET

### CORE AUDIENCE:

- Women 25-54 (primary)
- Multicultural audiences seeking authentic representation
- Suburban families
- Streaming audiences who loved Girls Trip, Bridesmaids, Schitt's Creek

### SECONDARY:

- Couples (relationship humor)
  - Anyone dealing with perfectionism/control issues
  - Female friendship celebration seekers
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## WHY IT SELLS

1. **AUTHENTIC DIVERSITY:** Natural, non-tokenistic multicultural casting
  2. **UNIVERSAL THEMES:** Everyone knows a perfectionist having a breakdown
  3. **PHYSICAL COMEDY GOLD:** Endless GIF and meme potential
  4. **FEMALE FRIENDSHIP:** Proven successful genre (Girls Trip made \$140M)
  5. **STREAMING FRIENDLY:** Rewatchable comfort content
  6. **SOCIAL MEDIA READY:** Every disaster is a viral moment waiting to happen
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## COMPARABLE FILMS & SERIES

### BOX OFFICE COMPARABLES:

- Girls Trip (\$140M worldwide, \$20M budget)
- Bridesmaids (\$288M worldwide, \$32.5M budget)
- Book Club (\$104M worldwide, \$10M budget)

### STREAMING COMPARABLES:

- Schitt's Creek (Emmy winner, massive streaming success)
  - Dead to Me (female friendship through crisis)
  - Grace and Frankie (older female friendship)
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## PRODUCTION VALUE

**BUDGET RANGE:** \$15-25M **LOCATIONS:** Georgia (tax incentives) - suburban Atlanta + rural B&B **VFX**  
**NEEDS:** Minimal - practical physical comedy **MUSIC:** Karaoke-heavy soundtrack with licensing opportunities **COSTUMES:** Suburban chic vs. Southern Gothic contrast

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## STORY & HOOK – WHY THIS STORY MATTERS NOW

In an era of Instagram perfection and helicopter parenting, women are burning out trying to be everything to everyone. Post-pandemic, female friendship and mental health are more crucial than ever. This film addresses:

- **Perfectionism Culture:** Social media pressure to have it all together
  - **Female Friendship:** Authentic relationships vs. competitive mothering
  - **Mental Health:** Normalizing breakdown as breakthrough
  - **Multicultural Relationships:** Real friendships across racial lines
  - **Midlife Crisis:** Women's stories beyond romance and motherhood
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## DEMOGRAPHICS



**PRIMARY:** Women 25-54, household income \$50K+, college-educated, suburban/urban **ETHNICITY:** 40% White, 35% Black, 15% Hispanic, 10% Other **PSYCHOGRAPHICS:** Overwhelmed achievers, friendship-valued, authenticity-seeking **VIEWING HABITS:** Netflix bingers, girls' night movie choosers, social media sharers

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## MARKETABILITY

**THEATRICAL:** Wide release potential, counter-programming to male action films **STREAMING:** Perfect binge-watch comfort content

**INTERNATIONAL:** Universal themes translate globally **MERCHANDISING:** Friendship-themed products, self-care tie-ins

**SEQUEL POTENTIAL:** Built-in franchise with "Hot Mess" brand **AWARDS**

**POTENTIAL:** Ensemble casting, female-driven narrative **SOUNDTRACK:** Karaoke hits + original music opportunities

### MARKETING PARTNERSHIPS:

- Spa/wellness brands
  - Wine companies
  - Female lifestyle brands
  - Friendship jewelry/accessories
  - Travel companies (girls' trip angle)
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## THE BOTTOM LINE

HOT MESS EXPRESS delivers what audiences crave: authentic female friendship, laugh-out-loud physical comedy, and genuine emotional payoff. With proven comparable success, diverse casting appeal, and endless marketing opportunities, this project offers networks and streamers a guaranteed crowd-pleaser with significant upside potential.

**THE ASK:** Greenlight for \$5M budget, target 2026 release, A-list female ensemble casting, experienced comedy director.

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*"In a world obsessed with perfection, sometimes the most beautiful thing is a beautiful mess."*